Amniotic Fluid

DEFINITION: Amniotic fluid is a clear, slightly yellowish liquids surround and protects the fetus during pregnancy. Normal Amniotic fluid is around 800 ml

Amniotic fluid is made up of fetal urine & fluid that is transported through placenta from maternal circulation.

Polyhydramnios

Polyhydramnios is defined as a state where amniotic fluid exceeds more than 2000 ml.

Risk factors

- Multiple pregnancy.
- Fetal abnormalities.
- Fetal skeletal malformations.
- Obstruction of GI tract- prevents normal ingestion of amniotic fluid.
- Rh Iso immunization
- Maternal Diabetes Mellitus.
- Spinabifida; Anencephaly, Hydrocephaly.

Diagnosis: Sonography-To detect Amniotic Fluid Index (AFI) is more than 20 cm. (Normal AFI is 8-18 cm).

Management

- Bed rest.
- Monitor weight gain.
- Remove excess amniotic fluid every 1-2 weeks through amniocentesis.
- Most women with mild polyhydramnios deliver healthy baby.

Oligohydramnios

It is a condition where the amniotic fluid is less than 500 ml in the amniotic sac.

Causes

- Failure of fetal kidney development
- Obstruction in urinary tract
- Intra Uterine Growth Restriction (IUGR)
- Post-term pregnancy
- Premature rupture of membrane
- Fetal anomalies
- Poor placental function.

Diagnosis

- AFI < 5-6 cm
- Small uterine size.
- Less fetal movements
- Prominent fetal parts on palpations
- Small for date uterine size.
- Fetal demise.
- Ultrasonogram

Prognosis: Depends on severity of disease.

Management

- Careful assessment of mother/fetus
- Frequent ante-partum testing
- Determine optimal time for delivery (early)
- Antibiotics/corticosteroids with PROM (Premature Rupture Of Membranes)

Ectopic Pregnancy

The fertilized ovum is implanted and develops outside the normal uterine cavity usually in fallopian tubes, rare on ovary, cervix or abdominal cavity.

Incidence



- Leading cause of death from hemorrhage in pregnancy
- Reduces fertility
- 1 in 100 pregnancies

Causes

- Scarring of fallopian tubes (Chlamydia/ Gonorrhea).
- More common with infection of fallopian tubes or surgery to reverse Tubale Ligation.
- Previous ectopic
- Multiple induced abortions
- Diethylstilbestrol (DES) exposure

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